

Credential & Education Sequencing Planner (CESP)

**Funding-aware, time-based planning
from day one of service.**

Service members make life-altering decisions in a fog of ambiguity.

The current transition process forces critical career and education choices into a compressed, high-stress window. Key information is fragmented, and the long-term consequences of financial and time-based tradeoffs are invisible until it's too late.

**Financial
Pressure**

**Late-Stage
Planning**

**Information
Fragmentation**

**Risk of
Underemployment**

The CESP makes time, funding, and tradeoffs visible.

Our purpose is to ensure education and credentialing decisions are:

- Intentional: Proactively planned, not reactively chosen.
- Financially Viable: Aligned with available TA and CA funding limits.
- Demand-Aligned: Connected to civilian labor market needs.
- Early: Made across a career horizon, not just at separation.



A Guided Tour: Planning a Future in Cybersecurity

Meet SSG Alex Martinez, an Army Signal Support Systems Specialist with 24 months until separation.

SSG Alex Martinez



Branch:
U.S. Army

MOS:
25B Signal Support Systems Specialist

Time to ETS:
24 months

Stated Goal:
Civilian IT Professional

Secondary Goal:
Cybersecurity Analyst

Step 1: Building the Foundation

SSG Martinez adds his primary goal: an Associate Degree in IT. The system instantly maps the cost against his Tuition Assistance (TA) funding.

	FY2026	FY2027
Degree Program	Associate Degree in IT	
TA Funding Track	\$3,000 used of \$4,500 cap	FY2026 TA Status:
CA Funding Track	\$0 used	FY2026 CA Status:

Step 2: Sequencing a High-Demand Certification

He adds CompTIA A+, a foundational IT certification, funded by Credentialing Assistance (CA). The planner recalculates funding usage in real-time.

	FY2026	FY2027
Certification	CompTIA A+	
Degree Program	Associate Degree in IT	
TA Funding Track	\$3,000 used of \$4,500 cap	FY2026 TA Status:
CA Funding Track	\$500 used of \$4,000 cap	FY2026 CA Status:

Step 3: Exposing a Critical Funding Conflict

To accelerate his path, SSG Martinez adds a second, more advanced certification, CompTIA Security+, to the same fiscal year. This action violates the annual CA funding cap.

	FY2026	FY2027
Certification	CompTIA A+ CompTIA Security+	Constraint Violation: CA funding cap of \$2,000 exceeded.
Degree Program	Associate Degree in IT	
TA Funding Track	\$3,000 used of \$4,500 cap	FY2026 TA Status:
CA Funding Track		FY2026 CA Status:

Step 4: Resolving the Conflict with a Simple Action

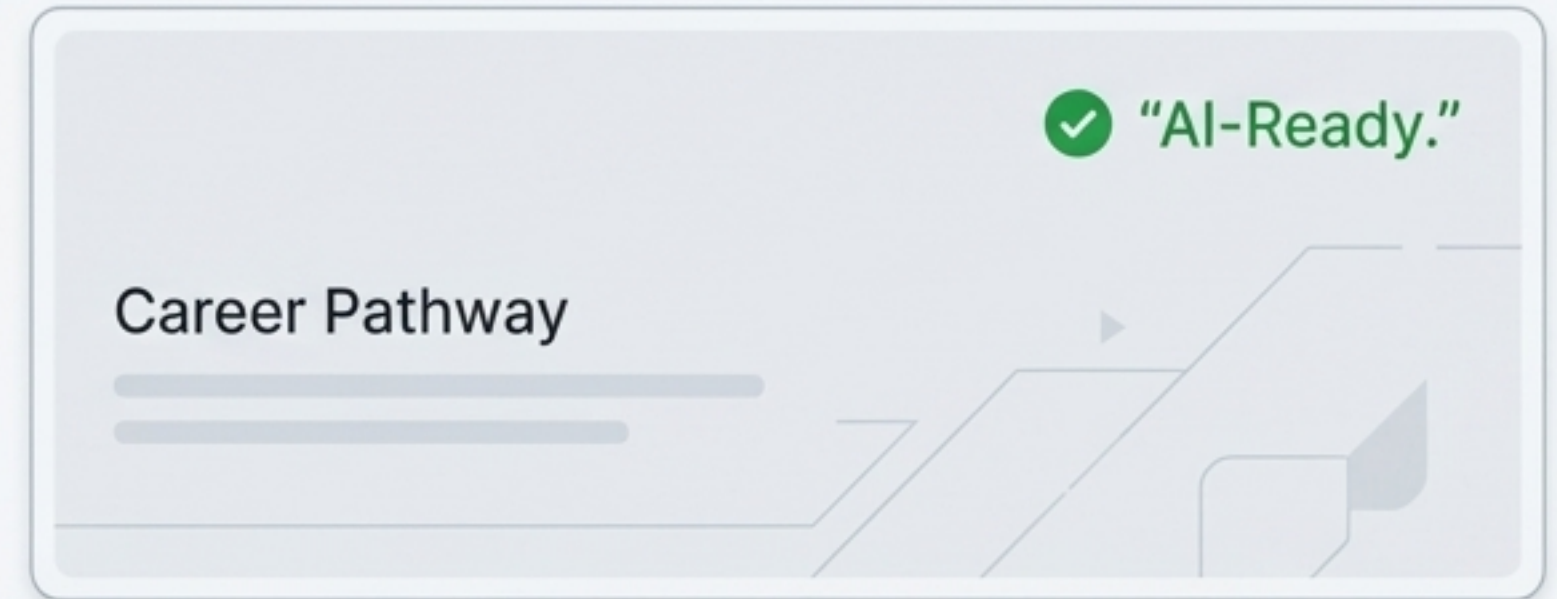
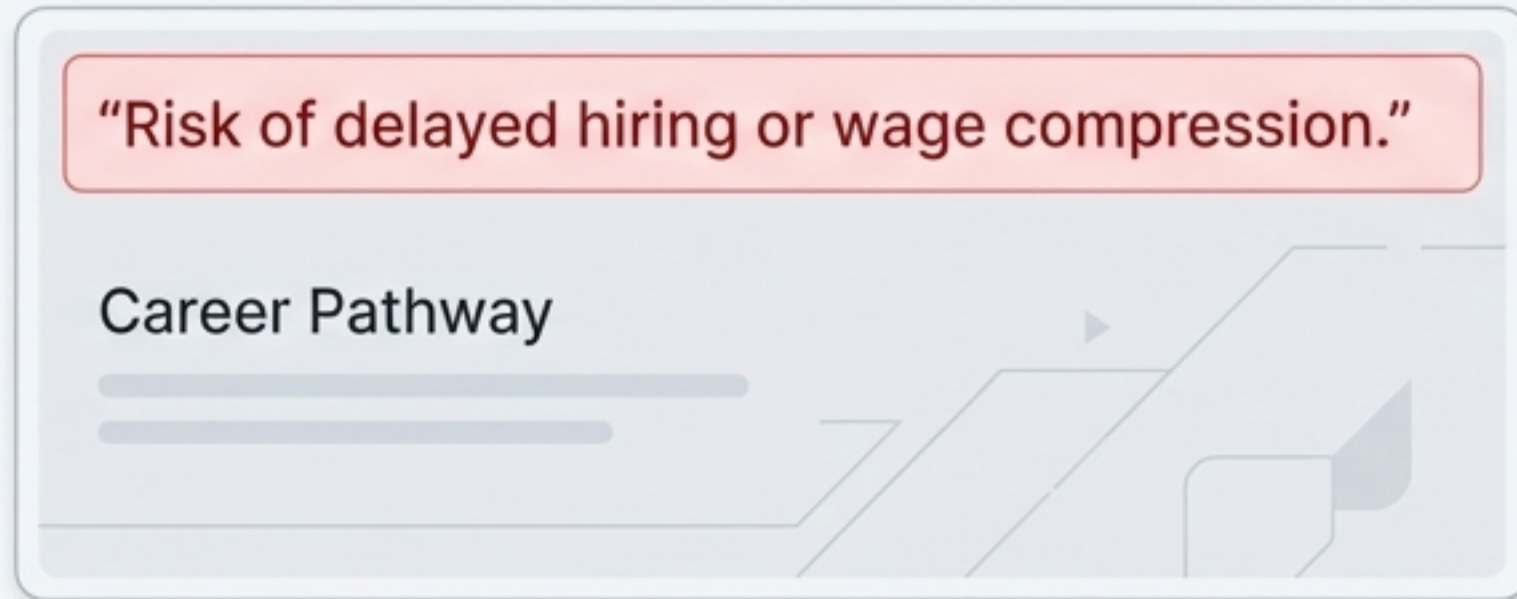
The system does not dictate a solution. It exposes the consequence. SSG Martinez sees the issue and drags the `Security+` certification into the next fiscal year (FY2027).

	FY2026	FY2027
Certification	CompTIA A+	CompTIA Security+
Degree Program	Associate Degree in IT	
TA Funding Track	\$3,000 used of \$4,500 cap	FY2026 TA Status:
CA Funding Track	\$500 used of \$4,000 cap	FY2026 CA Status:

Plan → See Consequences → Adjust.

The AI Literacy Gate: Aligning with a Ready Force

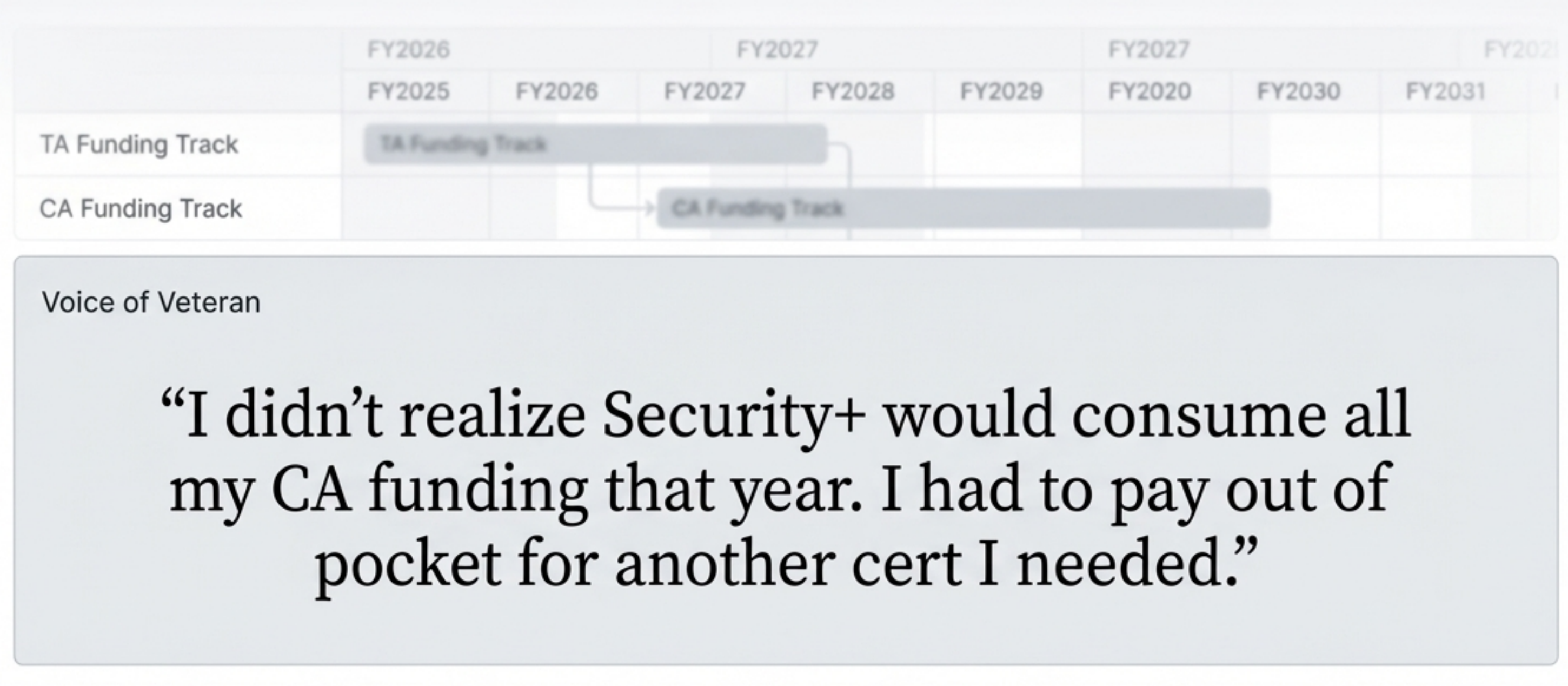
The CESP integrates critical readiness flags directly into the plan. A service member's AI literacy status, mapped to the DoD Campaign for an AI-Ready Force, functions as a "Go / No-Go" gate.



This reinforces policy alignment without coercion.

Humanizing the Tradeoffs with the Voice of the Veteran

Beneath the Gantt planner, the system surfaces short, anonymized quotes from other service members. This contextualizes data-driven tradeoffs with lived experience, humanizing the decision-making process.



Our Philosophy: A Governed AI that Empowers, Not Prescribes

**The AI does not optimize for the system.
It exposes consequences so the service
member can decide.**

This design preserves user agency and builds trust, making the tool a partner in planning, not an automated enforcer.

Strategic Impact: From Individual Plan to Institutional Readiness

The CESP is more than a planning tool; it is a strategic asset that:

De-risks Transition

Directly mitigates top financial and employment risks by making consequences visible early.

Promotes Retention

Enables service members to build long-term career paths, whether inside or outside the service.

Builds a Ready Force

Integrates key policy goals, like AI literacy, directly into career development.

Demonstrates Responsible AI

Provides a practical, scalable example of "governed AI" that preserves user agency and trust.

A Platform for Intentional Careers

	FY2026				FY2027			
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Education & Certifications	Associate Degree in IT							
	CompTIA A+							
					CompTIA Security+			
TA Status	● Approved - Full Funding				● Approved - Full Funding			
CA Status	● Approved - Full Funding				● Approved - Full Funding			